

Word family: **influence / influences / influenced / influencing / influential**

Base word: influence

Third-person singular: influences

Past tense / past participle: influenced

ing form: influencing

Related adjective: influential

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / related adjective (相關形容詞)

Useful constructions/extensions: influence on, have an influence on, influence someone, influence a decision, influence behaviour, under the influence of, exert influence, sphere of influence, influential person, highly influential

Your passage contains:

> “One person who has had a really important **influence on my life** is my secondary school English teacher, Mrs. Chan.”

and:

> “The reason she **influenced me** so deeply is that she changed not only my English, but also my mindset.”

Here, **influence** means:

the power to affect the way someone thinks, behaves, develops, or makes choices.

Meaning in this passage

Your teacher did not simply:

- * give you information;
- * teach English grammar;
- * help with one presentation.

Her effect continued over time and changed:

- * your confidence;
- * your mindset;
- * the way you communicate;
- * the way you approach perfection;
- * the way you see learning and character.

So **influence** here means:

****a lasting effect on someone's thinking, behaviour, development, or character.****

****繁體中文： ** **影響；對一個人的思想、行為、性格或發展產生持續作用****

****中文翻譯： ****

> “She has had a really important influence on my life.”

「她對我的人生有非常重要的****影響****。」

And:

> “She influenced me so deeply.”

「她對我產生了非常****深遠的影響****。」

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****influence = effect on someone/something (影響) — 影響；作用****

This is the broad core noun meaning.

****Meaning:**** The effect that someone or something has on the way another person or thing develops, behaves, or changes.

Practice 1 — Original

> “She has had a really important ****influence on my life****.”

「她對我的人生有非常重要的****影響****。」

Practice 2

> “Parents can have a strong ****influence on their children****.”

「父母可以對孩子產生很大的****影響****。」

Practice 3

> “Music had a major influence on his career.”

「音樂對他的事業有重大****影響****。」

****influence on X = 對 X 的發展、行為、想法或結果產生作用****

2. ****have an influence on (對.....有影響) — 影響；產生作用****

A major construction.

Practice 4

> “Teachers can ****have a lasting influence on**** their students.”

「老師可以對學生產生****長遠影響****。」

Practice 5

> “His childhood had a strong influence on his personality.”

「他的童年對他的性格有很大的****影響****。」

****have an influence on = 對某人 / 某事產生改變或塑造作用****

3. ****influence = lasting personal impact (人生 / 人格上的影響) — 深遠影響****

This is especially close to your passage.

Practice 6

> “My grandmother had a huge ****influence on the way I see family****.”

「外婆對我如何看待家庭產生了很大的****影響****。」

Practice 7

> “One teacher had a lasting influence on my confidence.”

「有一位老師對我的自信產生了****持久影響****。」

****influence = 一個人的言行、價值觀或榜樣長期塑造另一個人****

4. ****influence = power to affect decisions/actions (影響力) — 影響力；左右能力****

A major noun sense.

****Meaning:**** The ability or power to affect another person's decisions, opinions, or behaviour.

Practice 8

> “She has a lot of ****influence**** in the organization.”

「她在這個機構中很有****影響力****。」

Practice 9

> “Parents still have considerable influence over young children.”

「父母對年幼孩子仍然有相當大的****影響力****。」

****influence = 能左右他人決定、觀點或行動的能力 / 力量****

This is subtly different from:

> an influence = an effect.

5. ****influence over someone/something (對.....的影響力) — 左右 ; 控制程度****

Practice 10

> “He has considerable ****influence over**** the team.”

「他對團隊有很大的****影響力****。」

Practice 11

> “Advertising has influence over consumer choices.”

「廣告能在一定程度上****影響消費者的選擇****。」

****influence over = 對某人 / 某事的決策或行為具有左右作用****

6. ****influence = person/thing that shapes someone (影響來源) — 有影響的人 / 事物****

A major countable noun use.

Practice 12

> “Her mother was a major ****influence**** on her.”

「她的母親是對她影響很大的****重要人物****。」

Practice 13

> “Jazz was an important influence on his music.”

「爵士樂是影響他音樂風格的一個****重要來源****。」

****an influence = 對某人的思想、風格、行為或發展產生塑造作用的人 / 事物****

This is very useful because ****influence**** can mean both:

> the effect

and:

> the source causing the effect.

7. ****positive/negative influence (正面 / 負面影響) — 好 / 壞影響****

Practice 14

> “She was a very ****positive influence**** on me.”

「她對我是個非常****正面的影響****。」

Practice 15

> “Some friends can be a negative influence.”

「有些朋友可能會帶來****負面影響****。」

****positive/negative influence = 對某人的行為、態度或發展帶來正面 / 負面塑造作用的人或因素****

8. ****bad influence (壞影響的人 / 因素) — 帶壞別人的人 / 影響****

A common interpersonal expression.

Practice 16

> “His parents thought those friends were a **bad influence**.”

「他的父母認為那些朋友會**帶壞他 / 產生壞影響**。」

Practice 17

> “He worried that social media was becoming a bad influence.”

「他擔心社交媒體正在成為一種**不良影響**。」

a bad influence = 使某人的行為、態度或選擇變差的人 / 事物

9. **influence** = cultural/artistic source (藝術 / 文化影響來源) — 影響 ; 風格來源

A major creative-field use.

Practice 18

> “Traditional music is a strong **influence** on her work.”

「傳統音樂對她的作品有很大**影響**。」

Practice 19

> “You can hear several musical influences in the album.”

「你可以在這張專輯中聽到幾種不同的音樂**風格影響來源**。」

influence = 對作品、設計、思想或風格形成具有塑造作用的來源

10. **influences** = inspirations/sources shaping style (風格影響來源) — 創作養分 ; 影響來源

Practice 20

> “The designer talked about her main **influences**.”

「設計師談到她主要的**創作影響來源**。」

Practice 21

> “His influences include jazz and classical music.”

「影響他的風格包括爵士樂和古典音樂。」

****influences = 共同塑造某人創作、思想或風格的人 / 作品 / 傳統****

Here the plural refers to ****sources****, not abstract influence itself.

11. ****influence = verb: affect how someone thinks/acts (影響) — 影響 ; 左右****

This is the exact verb use in your passage.

Practice 22 — Original

> “She ****influenced me**** so deeply.”

「她對我產生了非常****深遠的影響****。」

Practice 23

> “His teacher ****influenced the way he thought****.”

「他的老師****影響了他的思考方式****。」

Practice 24

> “Friends can influence your behaviour.”

「朋友可以****影響你的行為****。」

****influence someone/something = 對某人的思想、行為、選擇或發展產生作用****

12. ****influence a decision/choice (影響決定 / 選擇) — 左右 ; 影響****

Practice 25

> “Cost ****influenced my decision****.”

「成本****影響了我的決定****。」

Practice 26

> “Her advice influenced my choice.”

「她的建議**影響了我的選擇**。」

influence a decision = 成為令某個決定朝某方向發展的因素之一

Importantly:

> influence ≠ completely control.

13. **influence behaviour (影響行為) — 改變 / 塑造行為**

Practice 27

> “Parents strongly **influence children’s behaviour**.”

「父母會強烈**影響孩子的行為**。」

Practice 28

> “The environment can influence how people act.”

「環境可以**影響人的行為方式**。」

influence behaviour = 改變 / 塑造某人的行動模式

14. **influence opinion (影響看法) — 左右觀點**

Practice 29

> “News reports can **influence public opinion**.”

「新聞報道可以**影響公眾意見**。」

Practice 30

> “His experience influenced his opinion of the issue.”

「他的經驗**影響了他對這個問題的看法**。」

influence opinion = 使某人的觀點朝某方向形成 / 改變

15. **influence = indirectly affect an outcome (影響結果) — 對結果產生作用**

Practice 31

> “Weather can **influence the final result**.”

「天氣可以**影響最終結果**。」

Practice 32

> “Several factors influenced the outcome.”

「有幾個因素**影響了結果**。」

influence = 對結果具有作用，但不一定單獨決定結果

This distinction is very important.

16. **influential (有影響力的) — 具影響力；能左右他人**

The major related adjective.

Practice 33

> “She became an **influential teacher**.”

「她成為一位很有**影響力的老師**。」

Practice 34

> “The book was highly influential.”

「這本書非常有**影響力**。」

influential = 能顯著影響人的思想、行動、文化、政策或發展

17. **influential person/figure (有影響力人物) — 重要人物；具影響力的人**

Practice 35

> “She is an **influential figure** in education.”

「她是教育界一位很有**影響力**的人物。」

Practice 36

> “Several influential people supported the project.”

「幾位有**影響力**的人士支持這個項目。」

influential person = 能顯著影響其他人的想法、決定或某個領域發展的人

18. **highly influential** (極具影響力) — 影響深遠

Practice 37

> “The research was **highly influential**.”

「這項研究具有非常大的**影響力**。」

Practice 38

> “She was highly influential in shaping the programme.”

「她對這個計劃的形成具有**重大影響**。」

highly influential = 影響程度非常高

19. **under the influence of someone/something** (受.....影響) — 在.....影響下

A major expression.

Practice 39

> “He changed his style **under the influence of** his teacher.”

「他在老師的**影響下**改變了風格。」

Practice 40

> “The artist worked under the influence of several traditions.”

「藝術家受到幾種傳統的**影響**進行創作。」

****under the influence of X = 思想、行為、風格等正在受到 X 的作用 / 塑造****

20. ****under the influence = affected by alcohol/drugs (受酒精 / 藥物影響) — 醉酒 / 受藥物作用****

A very important separate fixed meaning.

Practice 41

> “He was driving ****under the influence****.”

「他當時****受酒精 / 藥物影響駕駛****。」

Practice 42

> “She was under the influence of alcohol.”

「她當時****受到酒精影響****。」

****under the influence = 因酒精或藥物作用而令判斷、反應或身體能力受影響****

When used without specifying the substance, it often refers to alcohol or drugs.

21. ****exert influence (施加影響力) — 發揮 / 施加影響****

A major formal collocation.

Practice 43

> “Parents ****exert a strong influence**** on young children.”

「父母對年幼孩子****發揮很大的影響力****。」

Practice 44

> “The organization tried to exert influence on the decision.”

「這個機構試圖對決定****施加影響****。」

****exert influence = 主動或實際運用自己的地位 / 能力去影響結果或他人****

More formal than:

> have influence.

22. **use influence (運用影響力) — 利用人脈 / 影響力**

Practice 45

> “He used his **influence** to help the project.”

「他運用自己的**影響力**幫助這個項目。」

Practice 46

> “She refused to use her influence to gain special treatment.”

「她拒絕利用自己的**影響力**取得特殊待遇。」

use your influence = 利用自己能左右他人的地位 / 關係來促成結果

23. **influence with someone (對某人有門路 / 影響力) — 能左右某人**

A less common but established construction.

Practice 47

> “She has considerable **influence with** senior management.”

「她對高層管理人員有相當大的**影響力**。」

Practice 48

> “He used his influence with the committee.”

「他運用了自己對委員會的**影響力**。」

influence with X = 對某個人 / 群體能產生實際影響的能力

More formal and lower frequency.

24. **sphere of influence (勢力 / 影響範圍) — 影響範圍 ; 勢力範圍**

A major fixed expression.

Practice 49

> “The organization expanded its **sphere of influence**.”

「這個機構擴大了自己的**影響範圍**。」

Practice 50

> “The issue lies outside my sphere of influence.”

「這件事不在我的**影響範圍**之內。」

sphere of influence = 某人 / 組織能夠產生影響或控制作用的領域 / 範圍

25. **circle of influence (可影響的範圍) — 自己能左右的事情範圍**

A useful modern personal-development/business expression.

Practice 51

> “Focus on your **circle of influence**.”

「把注意力集中在自己**能夠影響的事情上**。」

Practice 52

> “Some problems lie outside our circle of influence.”

「有些問題超出我們**能左右的範圍**。」

circle of influence = 自己實際能改變 / 左右的人、事情或情況

26. **outside/beyond someone's influence (超出某人影響範圍) — 無法左右**

Practice 53

> “The final decision was **beyond my influence**.”

「最終決定**不是我能左右的**。」

Practice 54

> “Some events are outside our influence.”

「有些事情**不是我們能控制 / 影響的**。」

beyond someone's influence = 某人沒有足夠能力去改變 / 左右

27. **influence = social pressure or example (受別人帶動) — 受人影響**

Practice 55

> “Teenagers can be strongly **influenced by their friends**.”

「青少年可能會受到朋友很大的**影響**。」

Practice 56

> “She was influenced by the people around her.”

「她受到身邊人的**影響**。」

be influenced by someone = 自己的行為、態度或選擇受到別人的榜樣 / 壓力 / 意見所塑造

28. **be easily influenced (容易受影響) — 容易被左右**

Practice 57

> “Young children can be **easily influenced**.”

「年幼孩子可能很**容易受影響**。」

Practice 58

> “He is too easily influenced by other people's opinions.”

「他太**容易被別人的意見左右**。」

easily influenced = 自己的看法 / 選擇容易因別人而改變

29. **undue influence** (不當影響) — 不當施壓 / 操控

A useful legal/formal compound.

Practice 59

> “The agreement was challenged on the grounds of **undue influence**.”

「有人以受到**不當影響 / 不當施壓**為理由質疑這份協議。」

Practice 60

> “The court considered whether undue influence had been used.”

「法院考慮是否有人使用了**不當影響力**。」

undue influence = 利用權力、關係或壓力不恰當地左右另一個人的自由決定

This is an established legal concept and useful for recognition.

Important distinction: **influence vs effect**

This is one of the most important contrasts.

influence

= the power/process of affecting something.

effect

= the result produced.

Compare:

> “Her teacher had a strong **influence** on her.”

= 老師對她有很大影響。

> “The **effect** was greater confidence.”

= 產生的結果是更有自信。

So:

****influence = affecting force****

****effect = resulting change****

Important distinction: **influence vs impact**

**influence**

often suggests:

- * gradual;
- * indirect;
- * ongoing shaping.

**impact**

often emphasizes:

- * strong;
- * noticeable;
- * direct effect.

Your teacher's influence lasts for years, so ****influence**** is especially natural.

Important distinction: **influence vs affect**

**influence**

can be noun or verb and often implies shaping:

> "She influenced my thinking."

**affect**

is mainly a verb meaning:

> cause some change.

> "The experience affected me deeply."

****Influence**** often suggests direction or shaping of behaviour/ideas.

****Affect**** is broader.

Important distinction: **influence vs change**

**change someone**

= cause them to become different.

**influence someone**

= affect the direction in which they think/behave/develop.

Influence may lead to change, but does not necessarily transform the person completely.

Your passage actually contains both ideas:

> she ****influenced**** you

because:

> she ****changed**** your mindset.

The second describes a result of the first.

Important distinction: **influence vs persuade**

**influence**

= affect someone's thinking/behaviour, possibly indirectly.

**persuade**

= deliberately convince someone to do/believe something.

A teacher can influence a student for years without deliberately persuading them every time.

Important distinction: **influence vs convince**

convince

= make someone believe something is true.

influence

= broader; can shape:

- * attitude;
- * behaviour;
- * decisions;
- * style;
- * character.

So influence is much wider.

Important distinction: **influence vs control**

influence

= affect the likelihood/direction of a result.

control

= determine/direct the result more fully.

If price influences a decision, it is one factor.

If price controls the decision, it dominates/determines it.

Important distinction: **influence vs manipulate**

influence

is neutral by itself.

manipulate

often implies deliberately controlling someone, frequently unfairly or secretly.

Someone can positively influence you.

Calling it manipulation would add a negative meaning.

Important distinction: **influence vs inspire**

inspire

= make someone feel motivated, creative, or eager to act.

influence

= broader shaping effect.

Your teacher may both:

> inspire you

and:

> influence you.

But influence can occur without inspiration.

Important distinction: **influence vs encourage**

encourage

= actively give confidence/support to someone.

influence

= broadly affect how they think or act.

In your passage:

> Mrs. Chan **encouraged** you to speak up

and that repeated encouragement **influenced** your confidence and mindset.

Different levels of meaning.

Important distinction: ****influence on vs influence over****

****influence on****

often focuses on:

> the effect something has.

> “Her influence on me was enormous.”

****influence over****

often focuses on:

> power to affect decisions or behaviour.

> “She has influence over the team.”

So:

****on = effect****

****over = power/control dimension****

This is a useful tendency, not an absolute rule.

Important distinction: ****influence = effect vs an influence = source****

Compare:

> “Her ****influence**** changed my life.”

Here:

= effect/power.

But:

> “She was an important ****influence**** in my life.”

Here:

= the person who produced the effect.

Same noun, different referent.

Important distinction: ****influential vs influenced****

****influential****

= capable of influencing other people.

> “an influential teacher”

= 有影響力的老師

****influenced****

= affected by something/someone.

> “I was influenced by my teacher.”

= 我受到老師影響

Opposite direction of influence.

Important distinction: ****influential vs powerful****

****powerful****

= has great power/strength generally.

****influential****

= specifically able to affect people's opinions, choices, or developments.

Someone can be influential without having formal power.

Your teacher is a good example.

Important distinction: ****influence vs authority****

****authority****

= official/rightful power to make decisions or commands.

influence

= ability to shape decisions even without formal authority.

A teacher may have classroom authority.

But her long-term personal influence continues even after she is no longer your teacher.

Important distinction: **under the influence of X vs influenced by X**

Ordinary:

> “I was influenced by my teacher.”

= 老師影響了我。

More formal/literary:

> “My writing developed under the influence of several authors.”

= 我的寫作受幾位作家影響而發展。

Both involve shaping.

But:

> **under the influence**

by itself often has the special alcohol/drug meaning.

Important distinction: **under the influence vs drunk**

drunk

= intoxicated specifically by alcohol.

under the influence

can refer to:

- * alcohol;
- * drugs;
- * sometimes another intoxicating substance.

It is more formal/legal.

Important distinction: ****exert influence vs have influence****

****have influence****

= possess influence.

****exert influence****

= actively use/apply it.

> “She has influence.”

describes capacity.

> “She exerted influence on the decision.”

describes its use.

Important distinction: ****influence vs reputation****

****reputation****

= what people generally think about someone.

****influence****

= ability/effect on what people think or do.

Someone may have a strong reputation but little influence, or vice versa.

Important distinction: ****influence vs role model****

****role model****

= a person whose behaviour others admire and may imitate.

influence

= any person/thing that shapes development.

A role model is usually a positive influence, but an influence need not be a role model.

Important distinction: **positive influence vs good person**

Calling someone a:

> **positive influence**

means:

> their effect on others is beneficial.

It does not simply mean:

> they themselves are morally good.

Focus is on the effect they produce.

Important distinction: **influence vs legacy**

influence

= effect someone has on others, often while alive and afterward.

legacy

= what remains after a person/event, especially long-term achievements, reputation, or consequences.

Your teacher's influence may eventually become part of her legacy.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **influence** family is compact but extremely high-value:

- * **influence — effect** = 影響
- * **influence on** = 對.....的影響
- * **have an influence on** = 對.....產生影響
- * **lasting influence** = 長遠 / 持久影響
- * **influence — power** = 影響力
- * **influence over** = 對.....具有左右能力
- * **an influence — person/thing** = 影響來源 / 具影響的人或事物
- * **positive influence** = 正面影響
- * **negative/bad influence** = 負面 / 不良影響
- * **cultural/artistic influences** = 文化 / 創作影響來源
- * **influence someone** = 影響某人
- * **influence a decision** = 影響 / 左右決定
- * **influence behaviour** = 影響行為
- * **influence opinion** = 影響觀點
- * **influence an outcome** = 對結果產生作用
- * **influential** = 有影響力的
- * **influential person/figure** = 有影響力人物
- * **highly influential** = 極具影響力
- * **under the influence of** = 在.....影響下
- * **under the influence** = 受酒精 / 藥物影響
- * **exert influence** = 施加 / 發揮影響
- * **use your influence** = 運用影響力
- * **sphere of influence** = 影響 / 勢力範圍
- * **circle of influence** = 自己能影響的範圍
- * **be influenced by** = 受到.....影響
- * **easily influenced** = 容易受人左右
- * **undue influence** = 不當影響 / 施壓

The main semantic branches are:

- > **effect on development, behaviour, or thought**
- > **power to affect decisions and behaviour**
- > **a person or thing serving as the source of that effect**
- > **verb: cause such an effect**

plus the lexicalized expression:

- > **under the influence** = affected by alcohol/drugs

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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influence — effect	某人 / 某事對另一人的思想、行為、發展或結果所產生的作用
influence on	對指定人 / 事的發展、選擇或狀態產生的影響
lasting influence	長期持續塑造某人的思想、行為或發展的影響
influence — power	能夠左右別人的決定、觀點或行為的能力
influence over	對某人 / 某事具有實際左右能力
an influence — source	對某人的思想、行為、風格或發展產生塑造作用的人 / 事物
positive influence	對別人的行為、發展或態度產生有益作用的人 / 因素
negative/bad influence	令別人的行為、選擇或發展變差的人 / 因素
creative influences	共同塑造某人作品、風格或思想的來源
influence — verb	對某人的思想、行為、選擇或某事的結果產生塑造作用
influence a decision	成為令某項決定朝某方向形成的因素
influence behaviour	改變 / 塑造某人的行動模式
influence opinion	改變 / 塑造某人的觀點或態度
influence outcome	對結果產生作用，但不一定完全決定結果
influential	能顯著影響他人的思想、行為、文化或某領域發展
under the influence of	思想、行為或風格受到某個人 / 因素塑造
under the influence	因酒精 / 藥物作用而使判斷、反應或身體能力受影響
exert influence	主動運用自己的地位、關係或能力去影響別人 / 結果
sphere of influence	某人 / 組織能實際產生影響的領域或範圍
be influenced by	自己的思想、行為或選擇受到外部因素塑造
undue influence	透過不恰當的壓力、權力或關係左右他人的自由決定

For your original passage

You actually use ****influence**** twice:

> “One person who has had a really important ****influence on my life**** is my secondary school English teacher...”

and:

> “The reason she ****influenced me**** so deeply is that she changed not only my English, but also my mindset.”

These map neatly onto the noun and verb:

****influence — noun****

> ****have an influence on my life****

= **「對我的人生產生影響」**

influence — verb

> **she influenced me deeply**

= **「她深深影響了我」**

And the passage gives very concrete evidence for what that influence consisted of:

> she encouraged you to speak up

> → you became more confident

> she told you not to chase perfection

> → your mindset changed

> she valued genuine communication

> → you changed the way you present yourself

> her words stayed with you

> → the influence continued long after the class ended.

So this is an excellent example of **influence** being different from a short-term **effect**.

Her influence is:

> **long-lasting**

> **developmental**

> **personal**

> **internalized**

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **have an influence on someone**

> = 對某人產生影響

> **be an influence on someone**

> = 成為影響某人的 / 因素

> **influence someone**

> = 影響某人

> **influence a decision**

> = 左右決定

> ****influence behaviour****

> = 影響行為

> ****positive influence****

> = 正面影響

> ****bad influence****

> = 不良影響

> ****an influential teacher****

> = 很有影響力的老師

> ****be influenced by someone****

> = 受到某人影響

> ****under the influence of an artist****

> = 受到某位藝術家影響

> ****under the influence****

> = 受酒精 / 藥物影響

> ****exert influence****

> = 施加 / 發揮影響力

> ****sphere of influence****

> = 影響範圍

So ****influence**** is richer than simply:

> ****influence = 影響****

The key semantic map is:

****INFLUENCE — noun****

→ the effect produced

****INFLUENCE — noun****

→ the power to affect others

****AN INFLUENCE****

→ the person/thing causing the effect

****INFLUENCE — verb****

→ cause someone/something to develop, think, behave, or decide differently

****INFLUENTIAL****

→ capable of producing strong influence

And in your original passage:

****influence = “a lasting shaping effect on your confidence, mindset, communication style, and personal development.”****